

LATER WITTGENSTEIN

SYLLABUS ITEM 8, PAPER I SECTION A — Meaning and Use · Language-games · Critique of Private Language

ONE MOVE — OWNER FENCE — PROVENANCE — THE EARLY POSITION — FIVE COMMITMENTS — FOUR CONTINUITIES — THE AUGUSTINIAN PICTURE — PI 43 — FOUR REFUSALS — TOOLS AND TECHNIQUE — OSTENSION — THE PREPARED PLACE — SAMPLES — FAMILY RESEMBLANCE — THE THREAD — THE SERVICE RENDERED — LANGUAGE-GAMES — THE BUILDERS — PI 23 — GRAMMAR — FORMS OF LIFE — AGREEMENT IN JUDGMENTS — TWO READINGS — THE PUPIL AT 1000 — PI 201 — PI 202 — KRIPKE — THE TARGET — THE DIARY — THE BEETLE — CRITERIA AND SYMPTOMS — THE BEHAVIOURISM REPLY — SOLIPSISM — THERAPY — THE LEDGER — PYQ ROUTING AND THE SPINE

Read the cyan rail from stage 00 to stage 35: stages 00–35 are the complete core spine, and the single grey stage E is optional enrichment that is never needed for a core answer. Every stage uses a layout chosen for its own content — heads, columns, timelines, matrices, chains, ladders, ranked lists, formulas, stacks, trees, pills, bands and prose panels.

THE ONE MOVE — THREE PRINTED LIMBS, ONE METHOD

STOP ASKING WHAT A WORD STANDS FORASK WHAT IS DONE WITH ITNORM-GOVERNED ROLE IN A PRACTICE

THE THIRD LIMB IS A CONSEQUENCE

THE SINGLE CHANGE OF QUESTION

Investigate a word through its ROLE in a trained, norm-governed practice  
then turn that question on the INNER LIFE -> limb 3

LIMB 1 — MEANING AND USE

PI 43, hedged: 'for a large class of cases — though not for all — ... the meaning of a word is its use in the language.'

Use = circumstances + training + permitted moves + standards of correctness

Target: the Augustinian picture (PI 1) generalised into an essence

LIMB 2 — LANGUAGE-GAMES

PI 7: 'the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven'

PI 23: countless kinds; the multiplicity is not fixed; new games arise, old ones are forgotten

Held in place by a form of life (Lebensform)

LIMB 3 — CRITIQUE OF PRIVATE LANGUAGE

PI 243–271: private ostensive definition of logically private sensations

No criterion of correctness → 'here we can't talk about right' (258)

Not a code, not solloquy, not solitude

ANSWER LINEHe does not replace one theory of meaning with another; he replaces the demand for a theory with the instruction to look at what is done with the word.

OWNER SCOPE AND THE FENCE

7 OWNED PARTS OF 1122021 IS THE ONLY EMPTY YEAR3 PRIVATE-LANGUAGE PARTS2 TRANSITION PARTS

OWNED HERE

meaning as use with the 43 hedge: the Augustinian picture as one game; tools and levers; understanding as mastery of a technique

ostensive definition and the prepared place: samples and the standard metre; family resemblance and the thread

language-games, the builders, the 23 list: grammar, surface and depth; forms of life, agreement in judgments, bedrock

the rule-following paradox and its resolution; the private-language target, the diary, the beetle

criteria against symptoms, 580, avowals, the anti-behaviourist reply; philosophy as therapy; the break from the Tractatus

vs

NOT OWNED — ONE CLAUSE EACH

Picture theory, logical atomism, saying/showing, 'Whereof one cannot speak' — TOPIC 06 — a target here, not a limb

Verification, pseudo-statements, the Vienna Circle — TOPIC 07 — a rival, not an ally

Two Dogmas, holism, persons — TOPIC 11, Quine and Strawson

Fideist and religious-language uses of 'form of life' — PAPER II

Ryle, Austin, speech acts — broader ordinary-language owners

MECHANISM2021's Wittgenstein part — 2021 Q4(c) on 'Whereof one cannot speak' — belongs to Topic 06, which is why this clause owns nothing that year and why knowing the fence is itself a mark.

ANSWER LINEThe early doctrine must be known well enough to be left behind precisely — and then left alone, because expounding it spends the answer on another clause.

PROVENANCE RAIL — ALMOST EVERYTHING HERE IS POSTHUMOUS

PUBLISHED POSTHUMOUSLY 1953EDITED BY ANSCOMBE AND RHEESPART I = §1–§6932009 PART II RENAMED AND RENUMBERED

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>1921German <i>Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung</i></li><li>1929–32Conversations with Schlick and Waismann — never a Circle member</li><li>1951Wittgenstein dies — one philosophical book and one article published</li><li>1982Kripke, Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language — 'as it struck Kripke'</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>1922Bilingual <i>Tractatus</i> — never date the English 1921</li><li>1933–35Blue and Brown Books dictated (published 1958) — criterion/symptom, angina</li><li>1953Philosophical Investigations, posthumous; Anscombe and Rhees; facing pages</li><li>20094th edn, Hacker and Schulte: Part II → PPF, renumbered</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>1922–28Outside academic philosophy: teacher, gardener, architect</li><li>1936–49Investigations Part I composed and rearranged; 1945 preface</li><li>1958The Blue and Brown Books published</li><li>1899The duck-rabbit figure is Jastrow's — never attribute the drawing to him</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>1929Returns to Cambridge; 'Some Remarks on Logical Form' admits colour exclusion</li><li>1949–51The notes later published as On Certainty</li><li>1969On Certainty (Über Gewissheit) — unrevised notes</li><li>—Cite Part I by §; the numbering is identical across editions and translations</li></ul> |
| ANSWER LINEFour cheap marks: the posthumous and editorially arranged text - the 1921/1922 split - the 2009 renaming and renumbering - Kripke's reading is a reading.                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

THE EARLY POSITION, STATED ACCURATELY

ONE GENERAL PROPOSITIONAL FORMSENSE = DEPICTIONSHARED LOGICAL FORMSOLIPSISM AT 5.62ORDINARY LANGUAGE IS IN ORDER

WHAT THE TRACTATUS HELD

One general propositional form: 'This is how things stand'

Sense = depiction of a possible state of affairs; proposition and fact share a logical form that cannot be said but shows itself

Analysis terminates in simple objects: elementary propositions are logically independent

5.62 what the solipsist means is quite correct but cannot be said; 5.64 strictly carried out it coincides with pure realism

vs

THE TWO CARICATURES THIS KILLS

X 'He moved from an ideal language to an ordinary one.' 4.002 / 5.5563: everyday propositions are just as they stand, in perfect logical order

X 'The Tractatus ignored the self.' 5.6–5.641 treat solipsism through saying and showing

So the 'ideal language' left behind is the demand for a general logical account of factual sense, not a proposal to replace English

ANSWER LINEA candidate who cannot state the early position accurately cannot answer the 35 marks this clause has carried in transition questions.

FIVE COMMITMENTS DROPPED — AND THE REASON EACH FELL

DIVERSITY OF USEOSTENSION INSUFFICIENTCOLOUR EXCLUSION — A PRESSURESIMPLE IS GAME-RELATIVE

THE TRACTATUS COMMITMENT

1 ONE GENERAL PROPOSITIONAL FORM

2 SENSE = DEPICTION VIA LOGICAL FORM

3 NAMES MEAN BY STANDING FOR OBJECTS

4 ELEMENTARY PROPOSITIONS ARE INDEPENDENT

5 ANALYSIS TERMINATES IN SIMPLES

WHY IT COULD NOT BE HELD

PI 23: ordering, describing, measuring, reporting, hypothesising, story-telling, play-acting, riddling, joking, translating, asking, thanking, cursing, greeting, praying. No one form covers this.

'game' pictures nothing single; nor do 'the', 'if', 'five', 'perhaps', 'meaning', 'pain'. Picturing is one thing language does, not what it is.

PI 20–32: the same pointing can teach colour, shape, number, material or direction. Naming needs a place already prepared.

Colour exclusion: 'this spot is red' and 'this spot is green' cannot both be true, yet neither looks further analysable. Admitted in 'Some Remarks on Logical Form' (1929): 'A pressure, not a refutation — and he disowned that paper.

No Tractarian simple was ever exhibited. PI 47: 'simple' and 'composite' have sense only relative to a game. Is a chair simple? Its legs? Its visual image?

ANSWER LINEEach commitment falls to a different pressure, and the pressures are cumulative: what connects them is one diagnosis — a picture of how language must work had been mistaken for a discovery about how it does.

THE FOUR CONTINUITIES — WHERE THE VERDICT MARK LIVES

PHILOSOPHY AS ACTIVITYTROUBLE FROM MISREADING LANGUAGEORDINARY LANGUAGE NOT AT FAULTTHE BOOK CONSUMES ITSELF

CONTINUITY

Philosophy is an activity, not a body of doctrine

Trouble comes from misreading language

Ordinary language is not the culprit

The book consumes itself

EARLY STATEMENT

clarification of propositions; the result is not 'philosophical propositions'

4.002 the outward form of language disguises the thought

5.5563 everyday propositions are in perfect logical order

6.54 throw away the ladder after climbing it

LATER STATEMENT

§109 'a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language'

§115 'a picture held us captive'; §38 language idles

§124 'philosophy leaves everything as it is'

§133 not a method but methods, like different therapies

MECHANISMThe self-application difficulty is structurally the same in both books — a problem inherited, not acquired. Saying so in one sentence is a first-class exam observation.

ANSWER LINEThe later work retains the aim of dissolving confusion and abandons the assumption that dissolving it requires exhibiting one hidden essence.

THE AUGUSTINIAN PICTURE AND ITS TRUE STATUS

PI 1 — AUGUSTINE QUOTEDPI 2–4 — THE BUILDERSONE GAME, NOT AN ESSENCENOT A REFUTATION

THE PICTURE

Every word names an object

Sentences combine names

The meaning is the object correlated with the word

Drawn from Augustine's Confessions at §1

→

THE ANSWER — CONSTRUCT, DON'T REFUTE

§§2–4 build a language the picture fits exactly

'Slab!' 'Block!' 'Pillar!' 'Beam!'

'Conceive this as a complete primitive language.'

THE VERDICT

One primitive language-game mistaken for the essence of all language

Not false — over-generalised

X 'Wittgenstein refuted Augustine's theory' throws away the characteristic later move

WHERE IT COLLAPSES

'the' · 'if' · 'not' · 'five' · 'perhaps' · 'meaning'

and 'pain' — the last refuge, dealt with at §§243–271

ANSWER LINEThe characteristic later move is to shrink an alleged essence into one case among many — and the third printed limb is that move applied to the inner life.

PI 43 WITH ITS ARCHITECTURE EXPOSED

THE HEDGE IS DOCTRINEUSE = NORM-GOVERNED ROLE40 — BEARER ≠ MEANING79 — PROPER NAMES SEPARATELY

'For a large class of cases - THOUGH NOT FOR ALL - in which we employ  
the word "meaning" it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word  
is its USE IN THE LANGUAGE.'  
PI 43

SCOPE LIMITER | WHAT IS DEFINED | THE DEFINITION  
'a large class | our EMPLOYMENT of | the NORM-GOVERNED ROLE  
of cases, | the word 'meaning' - | of an expression in  
though not | not an entity called | a practice  
for all' | Meaning |

QUOTING 43 WITHOUT THE HEDGE IS THE COMMONEST MISQUOTATION HERE

MECHANISM§40 separates the bearer of a name from its meaning — when Mr N. N. dies the name does not become meaningless — and §79 treats proper names separately. Both show the hedge is doctrine, not politeness.

ANSWER LINEThe hedge exists to stop use becoming a second essence, which is exactly what the Tractatus's logical form had been.

FOUR REFUSALS AND THE WORKED CASE

NOT FREQUENCYNOT USEFULNESSNOT INTENTIONNOT A LICENCESAME SOUND, FOUR JOBS

THE FOUR REFUSALS

X frequency — a statistical fact about a population, not a norm

X usefulness — a useless sentence can be fully meaningful

X the speaker's intention — that restores a private determinant §258 destroys

X a licence — a speaker can misuse a word, and that possibility is what makes it a word

THE WORKED CASE

'Water!' shouted at a fire = an alarm

asked at a table = a request

written on a phial = a label

said at a chemical formula = an identification

Same sound, four jobs — and the meaning is not a fifth thing standing behind them

THE LIVE TENSION — CONCEDE IT

If meaning is use, how is a new use distinguished from a wrong one?

Poetic extension, metaphor, technical redefinition and simple error all look, from outside, like departures from practice

Wittgenstein's resources: grammar, training, surroundings. Whether they always suffice is genuinely open

ANSWER LINEWrite norm-governed role the first time you write 'use', and the 'whatever people do is correct' objection is closed before the examiner can raise it.

TOOLS, LEVERS AND MASTERY OF A TECHNIQUE

PI 11 — THE TOOL-BOXPI 12 — LOCOMOTIVE HANDLESPI 199 — MASTERY OF A TECHNIQUEPERFORMANCE IS DEFEASIBLE

THE TWO IMAGES

§11 'Think of the tools in a tool-box: a hammer, pliers, a saw, a screwdriver, a rule, a glue-pot, glue, nails and screws. The functions of words are as diverse as the functions of these objects.'

§12 In a locomotive cab the handles all look alike: one is a crank movable continuously, one a switch with two positions, one a brake-lever that resists more the harder it is pulled. Uniform appearance, different function.

UNDERSTANDING REDESCRIBED

§199 'To understand a sentence means to understand a language. To understand a language means to be master of a technique.'

§§151–155 the inner flash can occur and be followed by failure; fluent understanding often involves no such episode — so the flash was never the criterion

THE ARGUMENT SHAPE — USED FOUR TIMES IN THIS CLAUSE

propose an inner item as what a mental achievement consists in — produce a case with the item and without the achievement — and a case with the achievement and without the item → the identification fails

The same shape runs at §§28–31, §§143–155, §201 and §258. Naming it once is worth a mark.

MECHANISMThis is not behaviourism: the criterion of understanding is what one does, but performance is defeasible in both directions — one may understand and be unable to perform, or perform once by luck.

ANSWER LINEUniformity of appearance across words tempts us to expect uniformity of function, and that expectation is a grammatical illusion rather than a discovery.

OSTENSION — ONE GESTURE, SIX POSSIBLE LESSONS

PI 28 — VARIOUSLY INTERPRETEDPI 29–30 — THE REPAIR BORROWSNOT SCEPTICISM

THE TEACHER POINTS AT TWO NUTS AND SAYS 'This is called "two"'

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OSTENSION — ONE GESTURE, SIX POSSIBLE LESSONS

PI 28 — VARIOUSLY INTERPRETED

PI 29–30 — THE REPAIR BORROWS

NOT SCEPTICISM

THE TEACHER POINTS AT TWO NUTS AND SAYS "This is called "two"  
PI 28: 'An ostensive definition can be VARIOUSLY INTERPRETED IN EVERY CASE.' Nothing in the pointing decides which lesson is being given.

NUMBER  
as it happens, the intended lesson

COLOUR  
both samples are the same colour

SHAPE  
both samples are the same shape

MATERIAL  
both are of the same stuff

THIS PAIR  
a proper name for these two objects

DIRECTION  
the finger does point somewhere

MECHANISM §29–30 the repair 'this **number** is called two' borrows an understanding of 'number'; '**one has already to know (or be able to do) something in order to be capable of asking a thing's name.**'

ANSWER LINE Ostensive teaching plainly **works** ; the claim is that **the pointing is not what does the work**, and reading §28 as scepticism inverts its purpose.

11

THE PREPARED PLACE, TRAINING AND THE REGRESS

PI 31 — THE CHESS-KING

PI 5–6 — TRAINING (ABRICHTUNG)

REGRESS OF EXPLANATIONS

TERMINUS = TRAINED ACTION

1 THE CONDITION

§31 'When one shows someone the king in chess and says: "This is the king", this does **not** tell him the use of this piece — **unless he already knows the rules of the game up to this last point** : the shape of the king.'  
The definition explains the use **when the place is already prepared** .

2 WHAT 'PREPARED' DOES AND DOES NOT MEAN

**Does** : occupying the **practice** — attending, imitating, being corrected, recognising that a word is being introduced for a role  
**X Does not** : already possessing the **concept** being taught — that would be viciously circular and make learning impossible

3 WHAT PREPARES IT

§55–6 **training** (Abrichtung) precedes explanation. The German is the word used for training an **animal** , and the choice is deliberate: the primitive stage is **pre-explanatory** . ! Mark this as interpretation.

4 THE REGRESS AND ITS TERMINUS

Every explanation stands in need of an explanation **of the same kind** , so the series does **not** end in a self-explaining item — it ends in **something one does**  
→ §201 'a way of grasping a rule which is **not an interpretation** ' → §217 'This is simply what I do'

ANSWER LINE Private ostension is ostension **minus training, minus correction, minus a prepared place** — which is why §258 is the **direct heir** of §28 .

12

SAMPLES BELONG TO THE MEANS OF REPRESENTATION

PI 16 — SAMPLES ARE PART OF THE LANGUAGE

PI 50 — THE STANDARD METRE

A ROLE, NOT A PROPERTY

§16 — WHERE THE SAMPLE SITS

If colour samples are shown **along with** the words in a language-game, it is most natural to count the **samples as part of the language** — not as objects the language is about.

§50 — THE STANDARD METRE

Of the standard metre in Paris one can say **neither** that it is one metre long **nor** that it is not — 'this is, of course, **not to ascribe any extraordinary property to it**, but only to mark its **peculiar role in the language-game of measuring** with a metre-rule.'

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR LIMB 3

If a sample were an **ordinary object** whose nature fixed a word's application, a **private** sample — a remembered sensation — might do the same job in a private language.  
§50 **removes that in advance** : a sample is a **standard** only because a practice of comparing, applying and correcting has given it that office.

ANSWER LINE Meaning is constrained but not arbitrary: **no essence is not no norm** , and what fails is only ostension's philosophical office of grounding meaning from outside all practice.

13

FAMILY RESEMBLANCE — THE SURVEY, CANDIDATE BY CANDIDATE

PI 65 — THE CHALLENGE

PI 66 — 'DON'T THINK, BUT LOOK!'

OVERLAPPING AND CRISS-CROSSING

|                           | AMUSE- MENT        | COMPE- TITION | WIN / LOSE | SKILL | RULES | LUCK |
|---------------------------|--------------------|---------------|------------|-------|-------|------|
| CHESS                     | yes                | yes           | yes        | yes   | yes   | no   |
| PATIENCE                  | yes                | no            | yes        | some  | yes   | yes  |
| RING-A-RING-A-ROSES       | yes                | no            | no         | no    | yes   | no   |
| THROWING A BALL AT A WALL | yes                | no            | no         | some  | no    | no   |
| OLYMPIC FINAL             | not for the player | yes           | yes        | yes   | yes   | some |

MECHANISM Every **column contains at least one 'no'** , and there is no row of all-yes features: even 'winning' shifts sense: in patience one wins against the **cards** . Result: '**a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing.**'

ANSWER LINE §65 puts the objection in the interlocutor's mouth — you never say what the **essence** of language is — and family resemblance is the **reply** , which is why the 2018 verb is 'help ... to uphold'.

14

THE THREAD AND THE STATUS OF THE BOUNDARY

PI 67 — THE SPUN THREAD

STRENGTH WITHOUT A CORE

UNDRAWN, NOT HIDDEN

TENNIS HAS NO THROWING RULE

§67 — THE NAME AND THE IMAGE

'I can think of no better expression to characterise these similarities than **family resemblances** , for the various resemblances between members of a family — **build, features, colour of eyes, gait, temperament** — overlap and criss-cross in the same way.'  
**The thread** : 'we extend our concept ... as in spinning a thread we twist fibre on fibre. And **the strength of the thread does not reside in the fact that some one fibre runs through its whole length, but in the overlapping of many fibres** .'

§§68–71 — THE BOUNDARY

§68 number is itself a family — cardinal, rational, real: **fibres, not species of one genus**

§69 we may **draw** a boundary for a special purpose; we do not know the boundaries **because none have been drawn** — not because they are **hidden**

§70 'But then the use of the word is unregulated!' — it is not **everywhere** circumscribed by rules; **nor is tennis** , which has no rule for how high one may throw the ball

§71 'Is an **indistinct photograph** always preferable to a sharp one? Isn't the indistinct one **often exactly what we need** ?'

MECHANISM X 'The boundary is unknown because it is **hidden** ' restores the essence-demand in epistemic clothing. §69 's point is that nothing has been concealed, because nothing has been **drawn** .

ANSWER LINE A rope is strong and no fibre runs its length — which is the whole reply to the anxiety that a concept without a core must dissolve.

15

FOUR DENIALS, THE OBJECTION, AND THE SERVICE RENDERED

NOT 'NO CONCEPT HAS AN ESSENCE'

NOT 'ANYTHING COUNTS'

2018 Q1(c) ANSWERED HERE

X FOUR THINGS THE DOCTRINE DOES NOT CLAIM

that **no** concept has necessary and sufficient conditions — 'triangle' and 'prime number' still do  
that no two games have anything in common — many share several features  
that definition is impossible or worthless  
that **anything** may therefore be called a game

? THE STANDARD OBJECTION

Everything resembles everything in **some** respect: a chair resembles chess in being man-made. A network of 'similarities' therefore constrains nothing.

THE REPLY, AND THE RESIDUE

**Relevance is fixed by the practice** , not by bare resemblance — by what we do with games, how the word is taught, which extensions are **accepted** and which are **corrected** . The concept is bounded by **use** , not by definition.  
! **Residue** : whether use bounds it tightly enough in **every** case is genuinely open. Concede it — that is the 'critically' mark.

THE SERVICE RENDERED — THE 2018 ANSWER IN FOUR STEPS

- 1 The **demand disarmed** — refusing to define 'language' is no longer a defect
- 2 The **analogy earned** — 'game' is the paradigm family-resemblance concept, so the analogy applies the very notion that dispensed with essences
- 3 The **picture supplied** — games have **training, rules, moves and standards without an essence** : exactly the combination the Tractatus thought only a shared logical form could give
- 4 **Relativism blocked** — games are norm-governed, so describing language as a family of games does not make meaning arbitrary

ANSWER LINE Family resemblance does not describe language; it **removes the obstacle** to describing it.

16

LANGUAGE-GAMES — THE DEFINITION AND THE THREE USES

PI 7 — LANGUAGE PLUS ACTIONS

OBJECTS OF COMPARISON

NOT MODELS

NOT ORIGIN HYPOTHESES

USE 1 — INVENTED PRIMITIVE LANGUAGES

§52, 8, 48, 130–131

Status (§§130–131) : **objects of comparison** , 'meant to throw light on the features of our language by way **not only of similarities but also of dissimilarities** '

X not simplified **models** - X not hypotheses about **origins** or child development

USE 2 — THE TRAINING PROCESSES

§7 naming, repeating after someone, pointing and saying

'I shall also call **the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven** , the language-game.'

The unit is never the sentence alone: **sentence + circumstance + activity + response**

USE 3 — ACTUAL COMPLETE PRACTICES

§23 's list — see the next stage

**Why the word 'game'** : games are the paradigm of something **rule-governed without an essence** ; they have **moves** ; they involve **training** : a move is intelligible only **within** the game

X It does **not** carry triviality, arbitrary invention or competition — the objection 'language is too serious to be a game' trades on connotations he does not use

ANSWER LINE Language-games are not what language is **like** ; they are how language is **looked at** — and that is why calling them a theory misses the method.

17

THE BUILDERS, WORKED RATHER THAN TOLD

FOUR WORDS

COMPLETE FOR ITS PURPOSE

PI 19–20 — WORD OR SENTENCE?

THE GAME

A calls '**Slab!**' → B brings a slab  
'**Block!**' → a block : '**Pillar!**' → a pillar : '**Beam!**' → a beam  
'Conceive this as a **complete primitive language** '

WHAT IT ESTABLISHES

- 1 a language can be **complete for its purpose** without **describing** anything
- 2 'Slab!' is nearer an **order** than a label; its meaning is its **role** in the transaction
- 3 meaning is displayed in the **trained response** — B's bringing the slab
- 4 Augustine's picture fits **this game** exactly, which fixes its true status

§§19–20 — THE ARGUMENT

Is 'Slab!' a **word** or a **sentence** ? It may be an elliptical form of 'Bring me a slab' — **or** our 'elliptical' sentence may be a **lengthened** form of theirs

Wittgenstein refuses to settle it by fiat: **what makes it an order is its place in the practice, not its length**

This is where the example turns from illustration into **argument**

ANSWER LINE Narrating the builders without stating what they **establish** converts an argument into an anecdote — and the argument is that **completeness for a purpose** is all a language needs.

18

PI 23 — THE LIST, THE HISTORICITY AND THE CLOSING CLAUSE

COUNTLESS KINDS

THE MULTIPLICITY IS NOT FIXED

DESCRIBING IS ONE ITEM

THE LIST — DELIBERATELY DISORDERLY

giving orders and obeying them   describing an object   giving its measurements   constructing an object from a drawing   reporting an event   speculating about an event   forming and testing a hypothesis   presenting results in tables and diagrams   making up a story, and reading it   play-acting   singing catches  
guessing riddles   making a joke, telling it   practical arithmetic   translating from one language into another   asking   thanking   cursing   greeting   PRAYING

THE TWO SENTENCES THAT FRAME IT

'there are countless kinds ... this multiplicity is not something fixed, given once for all; but new types of language, new language-games, come into existence, and others become obsolete and get forgotten'   'the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life'

THREE CONSEQUENCES

- 1 THE DISORDER IS THE ARGUMENT against one essence
- 2 DESCRIBING IS ONE ITEM — demoted from the paradigm it was in the Tractatus and in logical positivism
- 3 LANGUAGE IS HISTORICAL — conceptual change without a theory of conceptual change

ANSWER LINE Reproducing the list without the **closing clause** loses the textual bridge to forms of life — the sentence the 2022 answer most needs to quote.

19

GRAMMAR AND THE DIAGNOSTIC — 'IT IS 5 O'CLOCK ON THE SUN'

371 — ESSENCE IS EXPRESSED BY GRAMMAR

664 — SURFACE vs DEPTH

350–351 — NO GAME SPECIFIED

§371 'Essence is expressed by grammar.' §373 'Grammar tells what kind of object anything is.' The metaphysical question **what is an X?** is thereby transformed into a question about the **use of a word** — which is the therapeutic method in its working form.

§496 grammar does not **explain** but **describes** the use of signs. §664 in the use of a word one may distinguish **surface grammar** — how it is constructed, what part of speech it appears to be — from **depth grammar** , its actual employment: 'I mean this' and 'I intend this' look alike on the surface and differ in depth.

§§350–351 supply the diagnostic case: '**It is 5 o'clock on the sun**' is grammatically **impeccable** and has **no settled application** , because our practice of telling the time is tied to a place and to the sun's position. The sentence is **not false** : **no game has been specified** in which it makes a move. X Reaching for 'meaningless because unverifiable' imports **Topic 07** 's criterion and forfeits the boundary.

§89 cites Augustine on time — 'If no one asks me, I know; if I wish to explain it to one who asks, I know not' — as the classic case of the same phenomenon.

MECHANISM This is the **exact verdict-form later passed on the diarist's 'S'** : not a lie, not a falsehood, but a sign for which no game has been provided.

§371 'Essence is expressed by grammar.' §373 'Grammar tells what kind of object anything is.' The metaphysical question **what is an X?** is thereby transformed into a question about the **use of a word** — which is the therapeutic method in its working form.

§496 grammar does not **explain** but **describes** the use of signs. §664 in the use of a word one may distinguish **surface grammar** — how it is constructed, what part of speech it appears to be — from **depth grammar**, its actual employment: 'I mean this' and 'I intend this' look alike on the surface and differ in depth.

§§350–351 supply the diagnostic case. 'It is 5 o'clock on the sun' is grammatically **impeccable** and has **no settled application**, because our practice of telling the time is tied to a place and to the sun's position. The sentence is **not false**; **no game has been specified** in which it makes a move. X Reaching for 'meaningless because unverifiable' imports **Topic 07's** criterion and forfeits the boundary.

§89 cites Augustine on time — 'If no one asks me, I know; if I wish to explain it to one who asks, I know not' — as the classic case of the same phenomenon.

MECHANISM

This is the **exact verdict-form later passed on the diarist's 'S'**: not a lie, not a falsehood, but a sign for which no game has been provided.

ANSWER LINE

The trouble is never that the philosopher has said something **false**; it is that **surface grammar survived a transfer that use did not**.

FORMS OF LIFE — THE FOUR JOBS THE NOTION DOES

PI 19 · 23 · 241 · PPF

SPARSE OCCURRENCE

217 IS A RULE-FOLLOWING REMARK

JOB 1 — COMPLETES THE ACCOUNT

§19 'To imagine a language means to imagine a **form of life**' — said while asking whether the builders 'Slab!' is a word or a sentence

§23 'the speaking of language is **part of** an activity, or of a form of life'

JOB 2 — ANSWERS RELATIVISM

§§241–242 — see the next stage. This is where the notion is **argued**, and where the tenability mark lives

JOB 3 — MARKS WHERE JUSTIFICATION STOPS

§217 'If I have exhausted the justifications I have reached **bedrock**, and my spade is turned. Then I am inclined to say: **This is simply what I do**.'

! §217 is a **rule-following remark**. Using it to **define** form of life is an interpretive **extension** — mark it as one

JOB 4 — SETS THE LIMIT OF INTELLIGIBILITY

PPF / Part II §xi 'If a lion could talk, we could not understand him.'

Says : vocabulary alone does not confer understanding where activities, reactions and natural history diverge far enough

X **Does not say** : that cultures are sealed, that translation is impossible, or that cross-practice criticism is illegitimate. **Lions are not a culture**.

ANSWER LINE

The phrase occurs only a handful of times — §19, §23, §241 and PPF — so any large doctrine built on it is **interpretation**, not stated theory.

AGREEMENT IN JUDGMENTS — THE MEASURING TEST

PI 241 — NOT OPINIONS

PI 242 — AND JUDGMENTS

NO MEASURING, NOT INACCURATE MEASURING

241

'So you are saying that HUMAN AGREEMENT DECIDES what is true and what is false?'

'IT IS WHAT HUMAN BEINGS SAY THAT IS TRUE AND FALSE; AND THEY AGREE IN THE LANGUAGE THEY USE. THAT IS NOT AGREEMENT IN OPINIONS BUT IN FORM OF LIFE.'

242

agreement not only in DEFINITIONS but (queer as this may sound) in JUDGMENTS

remove the shared background

-> NOT widespread ERROR

-> NO SUBJECT-MATTER AT ALL

wildly varying measurement results = NO MEASURING,

not INACCURATE measuring

MECHANISM

Agreement operates **one level below truth-value** : it is the **condition of determinate assertion**, not its **ground**. Therefore disagreement — including radical disagreement — is **evidence of** a shared practice, not evidence against one.

ANSWER LINE

You cannot disagree with someone until you already agree with him about a great deal that neither of you has ever mentioned.

NATURALIST AND CULTURALIST READINGS — AND THE TENABILITY VERDICT

25 · 415 — NATURAL HISTORY

PLURAL OCCURRENCES

NO ADJUDICATION THEORY

NATURALIST / ANTHROPOLOGICAL

'form of life' = the shared **natural history** of human beings: reactions, the human body, common needs, primitive behaviour

§25 'commanding, asking, recounting, chatting are as much a part of our **natural history** as walking, eating, drinking, playing'

§415 'what we are supplying are really **remarks on the natural history of human beings**'

VS

CULTURALIST

'forms of life' in the **plural** = historically specific practices: religious, scientific, legal forms of discourse

Anchors: the plural occurrences; §23 's historicity — new games arise, old ones are forgotten: the manifest variety of practices

**Recommended** : the readings are **not exclusive** — the **shape** of the background is natural, its **content** largely cultural

MECHANISM

**Tenability test** : it would be untenable if consensus made claims true (§241 separates the levels), or if practices were immune to criticism (shared natural history and companson give purchase) — neither follows.

ANSWER LINE

**Tenable** as the **enabling background** of determinate speech; **untenable** as a theory of truth, of incommensurability or of ultimate justification. The honest gap is the absence of any theory of **rational adjudication** between practices.

RULE-FOLLOWING — THE PUPIL AT 1000

PI 185

'I WENT ON IN THE SAME WAY'

IT COMES NATURAL TO HIM

1

THE TEMPTING PICTURE

To follow a rule is to have it **in mind** and **derive** each application; meaning something determines every future step **in advance**.

↓

2

THE PRESSURE (§§138–155)

the formula does not **apply itself**; the examples are **finite**

a mental picture is **another sign**, needing application in turn (§§139–141)

the 'aha!' can occur and be followed by **failure** (§§151–155)

↓

3

THE CASE (§185)

Taught the natural numbers, then '+2' up to 1000, the pupil continues ... **996, 998, 1000, 1004, 1008, 1012**

We say: **look what you have done**. He replies: **'But I went on in the same way.'**

Repeating the examples does not refute him: **'It comes natural to this person to understand our order with our explanations as we should understand the order: "Add 2 up to 1000, 4 up to 2000, 6 up to 3000 and so on."**

↓

4

WHAT THE CASE SHOWS

X **Not** that the pupil is right. X **Not** that we cannot correct him.

+ That the **correction cannot be derived** from anything already possessed — sign, examples, image or further explanation, since each stands in the same need of application.

The phrase **'it comes natural'** locates the divergence at the level of **reaction** — where the form-of-life background does its work.

ANSWER LINE

A rule does not contain its own applications; a **trained practice** contains them, which is why explanations end in **doing** rather than in **saying**.

PI 201 IN THREE PARTS — THE REDUCTIO

(i) THE PARADOX

(ii) THE DIAGNOSIS

(iii) THE RESOLUTION

INTERPRETATION = SUBSTITUTION

(i) THE PARADOX

'This was our **paradox** : no course of action could be determined by a rule, because **every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule** .'

'If everything can be made out to accord with the rule, then it can also be made out to **conflict** with it. And so there would be **neither accord nor conflict** here.'

(ii) THE DIAGNOSIS

'It can be seen that there is a **misunderstanding** here from the mere fact that in the course of our argument we **give one interpretation after another** ; as if each one contented us at least for a moment, until we thought of yet another standing behind it.'

**Key gloss** : interpretation = **'the substitution of one expression of the rule for another'**. Because an interpretation is **another expression**, it stands in exactly the need it was introduced to satisfy → the regress is **structural** — **the first step was the mistake**.

(iii) THE RESOLUTION

'There is a **way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation**, but which is **exhibited in what we call "obeying the rule" and "going against it" in actual cases**.'

MECHANISM

X **The fatal omission** : quoting (i) and stopping converts a **reductio** into **scepticism** — the single most damaging omission available in this clause.

ANSWER LINE

State the paradox as a **conditional** — if grasping a rule were interpreting it, then... — and the grammar of that sentence already signals that you know it is a reductio.

PI 202, AND NORMATIVITY AGAINST REGULARITY

OBEYING A RULE IS A PRACTICE

NO PRIVATE RULE-FOLLOWING

MISTAKES, NOT EXCEPTIONS

PI 202 — THE BRIDGE TO LIMB 3

'**"Obeying a rule" is a practice. And to think one is obeying a rule is not to obey a rule**. Hence it is **not possible to obey a rule "privately"** : otherwise thinking one was obeying a rule would be the same thing as obeying it.'

This does **two jobs**: it names the terminus of the rule-following argument **and** announces the private-language argument **forty remarks in advance**.

§258 is §202 **applied to a sensation-word**. §211 reasons soon give out — and then I **act**, without reasons. §217 'This is simply what I do.'

VS

NORMATIVITY ≠ REGULARITY

A **regularity** is described from outside; a **practice** involves **standards** by which a performance is **criticised**

A regularity has **exceptions**; a practice has **mistakes** — failures by a standard the agent himself acknowledges when it is pointed out.

A regularity can be shared by a crowd; a **standard can be misapplied by the whole crowd at once**

X 'For Wittgenstein, correctness is whatever the community agrees on' recreates at **group** level exactly the collapse of 'right' into 'seems right' that §258 exploits at **individual** level

ANSWER LINE

**Community behaviour is not the criterion**, or 'correct' collapses into 'usual' — and that collapse is the very thing the third limb is built to expose.

KRIPKE 1982 — REPORT IT, THEN RULE ON IT

SCEPTICAL PARADOX

SCEPTICAL SOLUTION

'AS IT STRUCK KRIPKE'

KRIPKENSTEIN

R

THE READING

§201 read as a **sceptical paradox** : no fact about my past usage, dispositions or mental history **constitutes** my having meant **addition** rather than the deviant function usually called **quaddition** — hence no fact makes '125' rather than '5' the correct answer to '68 + 57'.

Answered by a **sceptical solution** : abandon truth-conditions for **assertion-conditions**; what licenses ascribing meaning is **communal agreement**.

1

PROVENANCE

Kripke presents it as: **'Wittgenstein's argument as it struck Kripke'**, not as exegesis. Scholarly shorthand: **Kripkenstein**. Four words secure the scholarship mark.

2

THE OPPOSING READING

Baker and Hacker, and McDowell from a different direction: §201 calls the paradox a **misunderstanding** and supplies a **third part** the reconstruction under-weights. The text **dissolves**; it does not concede.

3

THE RULING TO GIVE

Philosophically **valuable** — it shows with unusual clarity why **neither interpretation nor disposition** fixes normativity.

**Exegetically doubtful** — a sceptical **solution** is precisely the constructive theory §§128 and 133 forbid.

! Optional only: the **plus/quas** reconstruction and the sceptical-solution debate.

ANSWER LINE

Name both readings, take a side, and give **one** reason — that is the whole of what a fifteen-mark answer has room for here.

THE PRIVATE-LANGUAGE TARGET — PI 243 AND FOUR NON-TARGETS

LOGICAL PRIVACY

IN PRINCIPLE UNTEACHABLE

HALF THE MARKS LIVE HERE

PI 243 — THE QUESTION, AFTER THE NARROWING

Monologuists are SET ASIDE: a researcher could learn their language. The real target is a language whose words 'refer to WHAT CAN ONLY BE KNOWN TO THE PERSON SPEAKING; TO HIS IMMEDIATE PRIVATE SENSATIONS', so that ANOTHER PERSON CANNOT UNDERSTAND THE LANGUAGE.

X A SECRET CODE

an **encrypted public** language, decipherable **in principle**; its words already have public meanings

X TALKING TO ONESELF

ordinary use of a **public** language, performed alone

X PRIVATE THOUGHTS

never denied; §304 protects them explicitly

X PHYSICAL SOLITUDE

a solitary speaker may use **public-type** criteria: stable techniques, repeatable circumstances, checkable applications

MECHANISM

Each non-target is refutable **by example in one sentence**, which is why a script that attacks one of them has visibly answered a question that was not asked.

ANSWER LINE

Reproducing §243's own **narrowing** before anything else secures the target-identification mark that most scripts lose in their first paragraph.

THE DIARY — PI 258, 260, 265 AND 270

PRIVATE OSTENSIVE DEFINITION

NO CRITERION OF CORRECTNESS

270 — THE MANOMETER

NOT ABOUT FALLIBLE MEMORY

1

THE SET-UP (§258)

'I want to keep a **diary** about the recurrence of a certain **sensation**. To this end I associate it with the sign **"S"** and write this sign in a calendar for every day on which I have the sensation.'

No definition can be formulated — 'but still I can give myself a kind of **ostensive definition**', by concentrating my attention and, as it were, **pointing inwardly**.

↓

2

WHAT THE CEREMONY ACHIEVES

'It serves to establish the connexion between the sign and the sensation' — but 'I impress it on myself' can only mean: this process brings it about that I **remember the connexion right in future**.

↓

3

THE COLLAPSE

1

THE SET-UP (§258)

'I want to keep a **diary** about the recurrence of a certain **sensation** . To this end I associate it with the sign "**S**" and write this sign in a calendar for every day on which I have the sensation.'

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2

WHAT THE CEREMONY ACHIEVES

'It serves to establish the connexion between the sign and the sensation' — but 'I impress it on myself' can only mean: this process brings it about that I **remember the connexion right in future** .

3

THE COLLAPSE

**'And here we have no criterion of correctness.** One would like to say: **whatever is going to seem right to me is right** . And that only means that **here we can't talk about "right"** .'  
§260 'I believe this is the sensation S again' — perhaps you **believe that you believe** it.  
§265 the memory-check compared to buying **several copies of the same morning paper** ; a table existing only in the imagination is **not** a table; 'justification consists in appealing to something **Independent** '.

4

§270 — THE CONSTRUCTIVE HALF

Suppose writing 'S' **coincides with a rise in blood pressure** a manometer registers. **Now the sign has a use** — and note that **whether I identified the sensation rightly has become irrelevant** .  
Whatever work the sign does is done by the **public criterion** . Omitting §270 leaves the argument purely negative.

MECHANISM

X **Not an argument from fallible memory** . The claim is that there is **nothing here for memory to be reliable or unreliable about** . What collapses is '**right**' , not 'S'.

ANSWER LINE

Where nothing could count as getting it **wrong** , nothing counts as getting it **right** — and a sign that cannot be misused has not yet been used.

THE BEETLE AND THE FIVE-STEP CORE

PI 293   DROPS OUT AS IRRELEVANT   EXPRESSLY CONDITIONAL   A SUPPLEMENT, NOT THE ARGUMENT

β

THE BEETLE (§293)

'Suppose everyone had a **box** with something in it: we call it a **beetle** . No one can look into anyone else's box, and everyone says he knows what a beetle is **only by looking at his beetle** .'  
The thing might be **different** in each box - it might be **constantly changing** - **the box might be empty**  
**Conclusion** : 'If we construe the grammar of the expression of sensation on the model of **object and designation** , the object **drops out of consideration as irrelevant** .' ! Expressly **conditional** : the beetle attacks a **model** .

1

A MEANINGFUL SIGN REQUIRES A RULE OF USE

a standard by which its application counts as correct or incorrect

2

A RULE REQUIRES A CRITERION OF CORRECTNESS

independent of the user's mere present seeming — §202 : obeying a rule is a **practice**

3

PRIVATE OSTENSION SUPPLIES NO SUCH CRITERION

the only available check is a **further seeming of the same kind** — §258, §265

4

SO 'CORRECT' AND 'SEEMS CORRECT' COINCIDE

and where they coincide, '**correct**' has no application — §258

5

SO NO RULE, NO MEANING, NO PRIVATE LANGUAGE

What **survives** : sensations (§304) : the solitary speaker ( **public-type** criteria) : the first/third-person asymmetry (§§244, 246) : the inner life as describable (§ 580)  
What is **contested** : the **memory** objection - **actual community** against in-principle shareable standards : whether criterial grammar respects **felt phenomenology**

ANSWER LINE

The diary carries the argument and the beetle removes a residual temptation about **shared** words; leading with the beetle reverses the order and weakens both.

CRITERIA AGAINST SYMPTOMS, AND PI 580

KRITERIUM / SYMPTOM   DEFEASIBLE   BLUE BOOK — DICTATED 1933-35   580 — OUTWARD CRITERIA

|                         | CRITERION (Kriterium)                                                                             | SYMPTOM (Symptom)                                                                |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Relation to the concept | <b>Internal / grammatical</b> — part of what it is for the concept to apply; taught with the word | <b>External / inductive</b> — a correlation experience has taught us             |
| How established         | by the <b>grammar</b> of the language-game                                                        | by <b>empirical investigation</b>                                                |
| If it failed            | we would no longer know what the word means                                                       | we would merely revise a generalisation; the concept is untouched                |
| Angina (Blue Book)      | the <b>bacillus</b> in the blood, which we have <b>defined</b> as the criterion                   | the <b>inflamed throat</b> , which experience has taught us usually goes with it |
| Pain                    | <b>pain-behaviour in appropriate circumstances</b>                                                | a raised pulse, sweating, a groan produced by an <b>actor</b>                    |

MECHANISM

§580 'An 'inner process' stands in need of **outward criteria** .' Step 3 is load-bearing: the circumstances fixing an inner concept **cannot be further inner items** , since a private criterion for a private criterion restarts §258 one level down — so they must be **outward** : behaviour, situation, the **surroundings (Umgebung)** .

ANSWER LINE

Behaviour is not what pain is ; it is what makes 'pain' a word we can have .

THE BEHAVIOURISM CHARGE AND THE FOUR-MOVE REPLY

307 — A GRAMMATICAL FICTION   304 — NOT A SOMETHING, NOT A NOTHING   308 — THE CONJURING TRICK   244- 246 — AVOWAL   354 — THE FLUCTUATION

THE CHARGE, RAISED AGAINST HIMSELF (§§307-308)

'Aren't you at bottom really saying that **everything except human behaviour is a fiction** ?' — 'If I do speak of a fiction, then it is of a grammatical fiction' .

THE REPLY IN FOUR MOVES

1 The **denial is of a picture, not a phenomenon** (§304) — 'It is **not a something, but not a nothing either!** The conclusion was only that a **nothing would serve just as well as a something about which nothing could be said** .' What is rejected is the **inner-object model** , not pain, joy or memory.  
2 The **first false step** (§308) — we begin by talking innocently of mental 'processes and states', leaving their nature undecided, and now the analogy which was to make us understand our thoughts falls to pieces ... **the decisive movement in the conjuring trick has been made, and it was the very one that we thought quite innocent** .'  
3 Criteria are not definitions — because criteria are **defeasible** , 'he is in pain' is **not equivalent** to any statement about behaviour. The **behaviourist asserts an equivalence; Wittgenstein asserts a grammatical dependence** . Pretence is not a counter-example — it is a possibility the account predicts.  
4 The **first/third-person asymmetry** (§§244, 246) — adults **teach the child new pain-behaviour** , so 'the verbal expression of pain **replaces crying and does not describe it** '; and 'I know I am in pain' can be said of me **only as a joke** . ! Not every first-person psychological sentence is an avowal: 'I was frightened last Tuesday' is a **report** .

§354 — THE CANDID ADMISSION

'The **fluctuation in grammar between criteria and symptoms** makes it look as if there were nothing at all but symptoms.'  
**Reading A** — candour about how concepts work . **Reading B** — the firewall is only local. **Recommended: A** , conceding that it is secured **case by case** rather than in advance.

ANSWER LINE

Anti-Cartesian without being a **reductive behaviourist** — and the single word that makes the position possible is **defeasible** .

SOLIPSISM — THE ROUTE CHANGES, AND THE VERDICT-WORD

5.6 - 5.62 - 5.64   DISSOLUTION, NOT REFUTATION   NO PROOF OF OTHER MINDS

EARLY — SAYING AND SHOWING

5.6 'The limits of my language mean the limits of my world'  
5.62 'what the solipsist **means** is quite correct: only it **cannot be said** ', but makes itself manifest  
5.64 solipsism strictly carried out **coincides with pure realism** ; the self shrinks to an extensionless point  
Mechanism: **saying and showing** — the doctrine owned by **Topic 06** , so name it in a clause and stop

LATER — GRAMMAR AND CRITERIA

The trouble moves from the **limit** of language to the **grammar** of the solipsist's words: the operative distinction becomes **criterion against mere seeming**  
**The dilemma** : either his terms — 'experience', 'real', 'mine' — are fixed by his **present seeming** , and §258 applies, so **nothing determinate has been asserted** ; or they are fixed by **stable, repeatable techniques** , and he has conceded the **public-type practice** his thesis denies  
Support: §244 avowal - §246 'only I can know' is false in one way and nonsense in another - §293 beetle - **§580** outward criteria — dismantling the **asymmetry** the solipsist needs

MECHANISM

**Not proved** : that other minds exist - that the external world exists - that solitude is impossible. §303 'just try — in a real case — to doubt someone else's fear or pain' concerns **where doubt has application** .

ANSWER LINE

The solipsist is not defeated by evidence but by his own sentence: **the thesis consumes the vocabulary required to state it** .

PHILOSOPHY AS THERAPY — DIAGNOSIS, METHOD AND THE TEST OF SUCCESS

38 — LANGUAGE IDLES   115 — A PICTURE HELD US CAPTIVE   123 — I DON'T KNOW MY WAY ABOUT   309 — THE FLY-BOTTLE

THE DIAGNOSIS

§38 'philosophical problems arise when **language goes on holiday** ' — German wenn die Sprache **feiert** , i.e. language **idles** : an engine running **without load** , not a vacation  
§115 **'A picture held us captive**. And we could not get outside it, for it **lay in our language** and language seemed to repeat it to us inexorably' — the captor is a **picture** , and the captivity is **linguistic**  
§123 'A philosophical problem has the form '**I don't know my way about** ' — **disorientation** , not ignorance, which is why more information does not help

THE METHOD — NOT PASSIVITY

§122 **perspicuous representation** (übersichtliche Darstellung) producing 'just that understanding which consists in **seeing connections** ' ; hence the importance of **finding and inventing intermediate cases**  
§127 'The work of the philosopher consists in **assembling reminders** for a particular purpose'  
§128 if one advanced **theses** , they could never be debated, because everyone would agree - §129 what is most important is hidden by its **simplicity and familiarity**  
§109 description replaces explanation; philosophy is 'a battle against the **bewitchment** of our intelligence by means of language'

THE TEST, AND THE THREE OBJECTIONS

§133 'there is **not** a philosophical method, though there are indeed **methods, like different therapies** ' ; the real discovery is the one that makes it possible to **stop** - §255 treatment of an illness - §309 **show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle**  
**Quietism** (§124) — 'philosophy **may in no way interfere with the actual use of language** ... it leaves everything as it is'. The **first clause bounds it to grammar** . I Residue: the discipline is narrowed **very severely** — a cost accepted  
**Self-application** — the claim is itself general; §133 's plural mitigates without removing a problem **inherited from 6.54**  
**Persistent problems** — the reply that the picture has not yet been fully exhibited is **unfalsifiable as stated** : the most serious methodological complaint

ANSWER LINE

The philosopher is not ignorant but **lost** , and what he needs is a **map of a town he already knows** .

THE CRITICISM LEDGER, RANKED BY FORCE

OBJECTION + REPLY + RESIDUE   15 MARKS = ONE   20 MARKS = TWO

| OBJECTION                   | STATED                                                                                    | REPLY                                                                                                           | RESIDUE                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Self-application          | 'philosophical problems are grammatical confusions' is itself a general thesis            | <b>§128</b> no theses; <b>§133 methods</b> , plural, like different therapies — no doctrine to be self-refuting | structurally the <b>same</b> as the Tractatus ladder ( 6.54 ) ; inherited, not solved      |
| 2 Normativity of use        | if meaning is use, what separates <b>correct</b> use from widespread <b>misuse</b> ?      | grammar, training and correction supply local standards; practice is <b>normative</b> , not merely regular      | dead metaphor, poetic extension and technical redefinition are <b>genuinely hard cases</b> |
| 3 Kripke (1982)             | §201 yields a <b>sceptical paradox</b> answered only by communal agreement                | §201 calls it a <b>misunderstanding</b> ; Baker, Hacker and McDowell read <b>dissolution</b>                    | Kripke says 'as it struck Kripke': <b>valuable, exegetically doubtful</b>                  |
| 4 Quietism                  | §124 removes philosophy's critical function                                               | §124's first clause limits it to the <b>use of language</b> ; therapy does not forbid reform                    | the discipline is narrowed <b>very severely</b> — a cost accepted                          |
| 5 Behaviourism              | public criteria make 'pain' <b>mean</b> pain-behaviour                                    | criteria are <b>grammatical</b> and <b>defeasible</b> - §304, §307, §244                                        | <b>§354</b> 's fluctuation means the firewall is secured <b>case by case</b>               |
| 6 Relativism                | if grammar rests on forms of life, can practices criticise one another?                   | <b>§241</b> separates agreement from truth; shared natural reactions constrain                                  | <b>no theory of rational adjudication</b> — the honest gap                                 |
| 7 Crusoe / solitary speaker | a man alone could invent sensation-words                                                  | <b>logical</b> privacy, not solitude, is the target public- <b>type</b> criteria remain available               | whether an <b>actual community</b> is required is disputed                                 |
| 8 Circularity of practice   | practice explains correctness only by invoking what practitioners <b>count</b> as correct | a trained normative practice is distinguished from mere regularity by the possibility of <b>mistake</b>         | whether agreement grounds normativity without circularity remains contested                |

MECHANISM

The ranking is itself examinable judgement: an objection is **stronger the closer it comes to the method** rather than to a doctrine, which is why self-application is first and behaviourism is fifth.

ANSWER LINE

Listing objections without replies is advocacy in reverse; supplying replies without **residues** is advocacy. A critical answer needs **all three** .

PYQ ROUTING AND THE ANSWER SPINE

7 OWNED PARTS   2021 EMPTY — TOPIC 06 OWNS ITS PART   PRINTED ANOMALIES RETAINED

| YEAR - PART - MARKS | DEMAND                                                                                               | ANSWER ROUTE                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2018 Q1(c) - 10     | How does <b>family resemblance</b> help uphold that 'Language is a game'?                            | §65 challenge — §66 'look and see' — the survey — §67 thread — four denials — games have rules <b>without</b> an essence — non-arbitrariness                                                                          |
| 2019 Q3(b) - 15     | Show how the critique of solipsism <b>culminates</b> in the critique of private language             | dissolution not refutation — 5.6 / 5.62 / 5.64 — <b>the route changes</b> — the dilemma (§258 / conceded practice) — what is <b>not</b> proved                                                                        |
| 2020 Q4(c) - 15     | Critically discuss the answer to §243's own question, quoted in the paper                            | reproduce the quotation — §243's <b>narrowing</b> — §258 — §265 — §270 — memory and Crusoe objections — §304 fixes the strength                                                                                       |
| 2022 Q1(e) - 10     | Establish the tenability of language as form of life — the paper prints ' <b>motion</b> '            | note the printed word — §19, §23 — §241 — <b>§242's measuring test</b> — naturalist/culturalist — tenable as <b>background</b> , untenable as a theory of <b>truth</b>                                                |
| 2023 Q4(c) - 15     | Main reasons for the shift from picture-theory to use-theory                                         | four <b>numbered</b> pressures — §43 with its hedge — games and forms of life — therapy as destination — continuity of clarification                                                                                  |
| 2024 Q1(d) - 10     | Why can there be no essentially private language?                                                    | target + <b>four non-targets</b> — five-step core — beetle in one sentence — the solitary-speaker qualification                                                                                                       |
| 2025 Q3(a) - 20     | Explain the transition, with reference to the quoted statement — <b>unmatched quotation retained</b> | reproduce the printed wording — what the Tractatus <b>really</b> held — the pressures — what 'empirically' means — the later account — <b>theoretical to therapeutic</b> , with quietism and normativity as the costs |

MECHANISM

**Answer spine, all lengths** : state the **change of question** — give the **limb** with its exact texts — give the **support** that makes it executable — name the **objection** and its **residue** — close with a **defended ruling** .

ANSWER LINE

Everyone else was hunting the hidden thing: **he was explaining why the hunt felt compulsory** .

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT — ASPECT-SEEING AND HINGE CERTAINTY

NOT A PRINTED LIMB   10 MARKS: NONE   15 MARKS: ONE SENTENCE   20 MARKS: TWO SENTENCES

ASPECT-SEEING — PART II §xi / PPF

Figure: **Jastrow, 1899** : Wittgenstein **reproduces** it. 'I see that it has **not changed** , and yet I **see it differently** ' . The **dawning of an aspect** (das Aufleuchten eines Aspekts) is 'half visual experience, half thought'.  
Seeing the rabbit-aspect **presupposes familiarity with the shape of a rabbit** — **mastery of a technique** . **Aspect-blindness** — full acuity, correct identification, no dawning — ties the phenomenon to the **experience of meaning** .  
It **pressures** the conceptually innocent **Given** ; it does **not** by itself refute every acquaintance theory.

ON CERTAINTY — NOTES 1949-51, PUBLISHED 1969, UNREVISED

Answers **Moore** 's 'Here is one hand' and A Defence of Common Sense — material owned by **Topic 06** . Some propositions function as **hinges** : they stand fast and make doubting, testing and knowing possible.  
Legitimate use here: **one comparative sentence** connecting hinge certainty to **§§241-242** and **§217** , both of which mark where justification stops.

MECHANISM

Both are **unnecessary for a competent core answer** : no routed 2018-2025 part in this clause owns either, and a paragraph on the duck-rabbit in a ten-mark private-language answer is a straightforward loss of marks.